Copy Attention in NLP

Annotated Research & Reference Index — Titles, Direct Download Links, and Study Notes

Scope. “Copy attention” is interpreted broadly to include copy mechanisms, CopyNet, pointer networks, pointer-softmax, pointer-generator networks, span/phrase copying, copy-augmented Transformers, and modern LLM pointer/copy behavior. The list prioritizes primary open-access papers and authoritative reference material.

Completeness note. No finite bibliography can guarantee every downstream paper because many systems use copying as a secondary module without naming it in the title or abstract. This document is therefore a comprehensive curated research index rather than a mathematically exhaustive census. This edition was re-checked against current web-indexed literature through 17 August 2026 and against the eight PDFs supplied by the user.

★ **Core reading** • Links labeled DOWNLOAD PDF point to an open PDF whenever available; OPEN RESOURCE is used for documentation/reference pages.

Collection update - 17 August 2026. The 8 PDFs uploaded in this chat are marked OWNED in green. The bibliography now contains 121 references. Section 10 contains the earlier 20-item gap search, and Section 11 adds 14 further references covering sentence simplification/editing, generative extraction, event extraction, RAG/prompt compression, grounded LLM copy decoding, and mechanistic induction/copy heads. Filename lookup: each bibliography entry includes a File name line. For the 8 OWNED PDFs, the filename is preserved exactly as uploaded; for other entries it uses the direct-download filename or stable source identifier.

Recommended reading path: Pointer Networks → CopyNet / Pointer-Softmax → Pointer-Generator → span/phrase copying → Transformer copy attention → LLM-era pointer/copy mechanisms → induction heads and mechanistic contextual copying.

#	TITLE / FILE NAME	DOWNLOAD LINK	ANNOTATION / WHY IT MATTERS
1. Foundations and General Copy Mechanisms			
1	**★ Pointer Networks** **File name:** *Pointer Networks.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	**OWNED - uploaded in this chat.** Introduces attention as an output pointer over input positions rather than only a context-aggregation mechanism. It is the conceptual ancestor of many neural copy and pointer-generator architectures.
2	**★ Incorporating Copying Mechanism in Sequence-to-Sequence Learning (CopyNet)** **File name:** *Incorporating Copying Mechanism in Sequence-to-Sequence Learning.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	**OWNED - uploaded in this chat.** Canonical explicit copy mechanism for seq2seq NLP: combines ordinary vocabulary generation with copying tokens directly from the source. Especially important for rare/OOV words and source-faithful generation.
3	**★ Pointing the Unknown Words** **File name:** *Pointing the Unknown Words.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	**OWNED - uploaded in this chat.** Introduces pointer-softmax: a vocabulary distribution and a source-location distribution are combined through a learned switch. One of the earliest NLP formulations of generate-versus-point decoding.
4	**★ Pointer Sentinel Mixture Models** **File name:** *Byj72udxe.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Extends pointer ideas to neural language modeling by mixing vocabulary generation with pointing into recent context. Useful for understanding copying as a language-model output mechanism.
5	**★ Get To The Point: Summarization with Pointer-Generator Networks** **File name:** *Get To The Point Summarization with Pointer-Generator Networks.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	**OWNED - uploaded in this chat.** The most influential pointer-generator formulation in NLP. It mixes vocabulary generation and source copying and adds coverage to reduce repetition in abstractive summarization.
6	**Sequential Copying Networks** **File name:** *1807.02301.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Extends token-level copying to contiguous source subsequences. It is an important step toward explicit span- and phrase-copying architectures.
7	**CopyNext: Explicit Span Copying and Alignment in Sequence to Sequence Models** **File name:** *2020.spnlp-1.2.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Models explicit copy operations and hard source-output alignments, making it useful when outputs reuse multi-token spans rather than isolated tokens.
8	**Copy that! Editing Sequences by Copying Spans** **File name:** *2006.04771.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Treats sequence editing as a combination of generation and span copying. Particularly relevant to tasks where most of the output is retained from the input.
9	**BioCopy: A Plug-And-Play Span Copy Mechanism in Seq2Seq Models** **File name:** *2021.sustainlp-1.6.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Uses BIO-style tagging to identify and copy spans and is designed as a plug-and-play addition to seq2seq models. It targets more reliable long-span copying.
10	**May the Force Be with Your Copy Mechanism: Enhanced Supervised-Copy Method for Natural Language Generation** **File name:** *2112.10360.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Adds explicit supervision to the copy/generate decision. The goal is to improve copy selection while reducing the excessive extractiveness that can arise in unsupervised copy gates.
11	**Pointer-Generator Transformers for Disjoint Vocabularies** **File name:** *2020.aacl-srw.13.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Adapts pointer-generator behavior to a Transformer when source and target vocabularies are disjoint. It is useful for seeing how copying can be generalized beyond identical surface tokens.
2. Abstractive Summarization and Copy-Control Architectures			
12	**Structure-Infused Copy Mechanisms for Abstractive Summarization** **File name:** *Structure-Infused Copy Mechanisms for Abstractive Summarization.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	**OWNED - uploaded in this chat.** Injects source structure into copying so the decoder can make better-informed copy decisions. It is a key example of conditioning copy attention on syntactic/semantic structure rather than token salience alone.
13	**Bottom-Up Abstractive Summarization** **File name:** *Bottom-Up Abstractive Summarization.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	**OWNED - uploaded in this chat.** Uses a separate content selector to mask or constrain pointer-generator copy attention. This 'bottom-up attention' approach explicitly controls which source tokens are allowed to be copied.
14	**Closed-Book Training to Improve Summarization Encoder Memory** **File name:** *D18-1440.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Studies over-reliance on attention/copying by adding a decoder that must summarize without direct source attention. Useful for analyzing the tradeoff between encoder memory and copy access.

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15	**Simple and Effective Curriculum Pointer-Generator Networks for Reading Comprehension over Long Narratives** **File name:** *P19-1486.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Applies pointer-generator decoding to long-narrative generative reading comprehension and uses curriculum learning. It shows the mechanism outside standard news summarization.
16	**Generating Abstractive Summaries with Finetuned Language Models** **File name:** *W19-8665.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Contrasts pretrained language-model summarization with copy-attention systems and discusses the extractive bias induced by direct source copying. Useful as a critical perspective on when copying is desirable.
17	**Improving Latent Alignment in Text Summarization by Generalizing the Pointer Generator** **File name:** *D19-1390.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Proposes the Generalized Pointer Generator, replacing hard exact copying with a softer learned editing relation. It targets highly abstractive settings where exact source copying is too restrictive.
18	**Concept Pointer Network for Abstractive Summarization** **File name:** *D19-1304.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Introduces concept-level pointing to encourage generation based on higher-level concepts rather than only surface token reuse. Relevant to the abstraction-versus-copying problem.
19	**A Robust Abstractive System for Cross-Lingual Summarization** **File name:** *N19-1204.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Examines cross-lingual summarization under noisy machine-translated inputs and includes copy-attention baselines. Useful for understanding robustness limitations of source copying.
20	**VAE-PGN based Abstractive Model in Multi-stage Architecture for Text Summarization** **File name:** *W19-8664.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Combines variational modeling with a pointer-generator network that uses copy and coverage. It is a representative extension of the PGN family for more diverse abstractive generation.
21	**Self-Attention Guided Copy Mechanism for Abstractive Summarization** **File name:** *Self-Attention Guided Copy Mechanism for Abstractive Summarization.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	**OWNED - uploaded in this chat.** Uses source self-attention to guide the copy distribution in a Transformer-based summarizer. The model explicitly addresses the problem of deciding which important source tokens should be copied.
22	**PROM: A Phrase-level Copying Mechanism with Pre-training for Abstractive Summarization** **File name:** *PROM APhrase-level Copying Mechanism with Pre-training for.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	**OWNED - uploaded in this chat.** Moves from word-level copying to phrase/n-gram copying and combines it with pretraining. It targets faithfulness and better transfer, including low- or zero-resource settings.
23	**Improving Copy-oriented Text Generation via EDU Copy Mechanism** **File name:** *2024.lrec-main.768.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Copies Elementary Discourse Units rather than isolated tokens, allowing semantically coherent discourse segments to be transferred. A modern example of larger-unit copy modeling.
3. Keyphrase Generation			
24	**Deep Keyphrase Generation** **File name:** *P17-1054.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Seminal neural keyphrase-generation work commonly associated with CopyRNN. Copying handles present and rare keyphrases while the decoder can still generate absent keyphrases.
25	**Keyphrase Generation with Correlation Constraints** **File name:** *D18-1439.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Builds on copy-based keyphrase generation and adds constraints modeling relationships among multiple generated phrases. Useful for studying repetition and diversity in multi-output copy decoding.
26	**Semi-Supervised Learning for Neural Keyphrase Generation** **File name:** *D18-1447.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Extends neural generative keyphrase models into a semi-supervised setting. It is part of the CopyRNN lineage and illustrates how copy-based generation is trained with limited labeled data.
27	**An Integrated Approach for Keyphrase Generation via Exploring the Power of Retrieval and Extraction** **File name:** *N19-1292.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Combines retrieval/extraction signals with neural generation to guide and correct keyphrase predictions. Relevant to hybrid systems where copying and external evidence complement generation.
28	**Diverse Keyphrase Generation with Neural Unlikelihood Training** **File name:** *2020.coling-main.462.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Addresses repetition and lack of diversity in neural keyphrase generation, a common side effect in copy-capable seq2seq models. Useful for decoding/training strategies around copy-heavy outputs.
29	**Select, Extract and Generate: Neural Keyphrase Generation with Layer-wise Coverage Attention** **File name:** *2021.acl-long.111.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Adds an explicit copy-attention layer on top of a Transformer decoder and combines selection, extraction and generation. It is a clear Transformer-era copy-attention implementation.

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30	**SGG: Learning to Select, Guide, and Generate for Keyphrase Generation** **File name:** *2021.naacl-main.455.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Uses selection/pointer behavior for present keyphrases and generative decoding for others. It provides a structured way to divide extraction/copying from free generation.
31	**Heterogeneous Graph Neural Networks for Keyphrase Generation** **File name:** *2021.emnlp-main.213.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Combines graph-based representations with copy-aware neural generation, including evidence from source and related context. Useful for copy mechanisms that operate over richer representations.
32	**Structure-Augmented Keyphrase Generation** **File name:** *2021.emnlp-main.209.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Uses document structure to improve keyphrase generation while retaining copy-capable decoding. Relevant to incorporating global structure into source selection and copying.
33	**Automatic Keyphrase Generation by Incorporating Dual Copy Mechanisms in Sequence-to-Sequence Learning** **File name:** *2022.coling-1.204.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Explicitly introduces dual copy mechanisms to identify and copy useful seed words during keyphrase generation. A direct paper for researchers studying multiple copy sources/gates.
4. Question Generation and Generative QA			
34	**Machine Comprehension by Text-to-Text Neural Question Generation** **File name:** *W17-2603.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Uses pointer-softmax so questions can copy words directly from the source document. It is an early bridge between reading comprehension and copy-augmented question generation.
35	**Neural Models for Key Phrase Extraction and Question Generation** **File name:** *W18-2609.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Combines keyphrase extraction with neural question generation and source copying. It is useful for understanding how answer/keyphrase selection interacts with copy decoding.
36	**Paragraph-level Neural Question Generation with Maxout Pointer and Gated Self-attention Networks** **File name:** *D18-1424.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Introduces a maxout pointer mechanism for long paragraph inputs. The design aims to reduce repeated or erroneous copying when the same word occurs many times.
37	**Answer-focused and Position-aware Neural Question Generation** **File name:** *D18-1427.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Makes question generation explicitly aware of answer content and positions and evaluates copy/pointer-style decoding. Useful for answer-conditioned source copying.
38	**Improving Question Generation With to the Point Context** **File name:** *D19-1317.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Uses dual copying from different context representations, including unstructured text and extracted relational information. It illustrates multi-source copy control in QG.
39	**Generating Highly Relevant Questions** **File name:** *D19-1614.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Uses a partial copy mechanism that can produce variants related to source words instead of requiring exact whole-word copying. Relevant to morphology-aware and flexible copying.
40	**Neural Question Generation using Interrogative Phrases** **File name:** *W19-8613.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Combines interrogative-phrase modeling with copy and coverage mechanisms. It is useful for studying how question-type planning interacts with source copying.
41	**Vocabulary Matters: A Simple yet Effective Approach to Paragraph-level Neural Question Generation** **File name:** *2020.aacl-main.78.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Adds a dynamic paragraph-specific vocabulary and persistent copy attention. The extended vocabulary lets the model emit source words that are outside the fixed global vocabulary.
42	**CopyBERT: A Unified Approach to Question Generation with Self-Attention** **File name:** *2020.nlp4convai-1.3.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Adapts copying to a BERT/self-attention-based question-generation architecture. It is a practical example of carrying pointer-style source reuse into pretrained Transformer models.
43	**A Question Type Driven and Copy Loss Enhanced Framework for Answer-Agnostic Neural Question Generation** **File name:** *2020.ngt-1.8.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Adds a copy-oriented loss so important source words are more likely to be transferred into generated questions. Useful for explicitly supervising copy behavior rather than relying only on attention.
44	**A Generator-Evaluator Framework for Question Generation from Text** **File name:** *K19-1076.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Pairs a question generator with an evaluator and uses source-copy/coverage behavior to improve relevance and fidelity. It shows copy mechanisms inside a larger generate-and-rank framework.
5. Grammatical Error Correction, Translation, Normalization and Morphology			

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45	**Improving Grammatical Error Correction via Pre-Training a Copy-Augmented Architecture with Unlabeled Data** **File name:** *N19-1014.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Adds a copy mechanism to a Transformer for GEC, where most source tokens should remain unchanged. It is one of the clearest examples of copy attention as a strong task-specific inductive bias.
46	**A Neural Grammatical Error Correction System Built on Better Pre-training and Sequential Transfer Learning** **File name:** *W19-4423.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Uses copy-augmented GEC models and analyzes copy-attention scores. Helpful for practical ensemble behavior and the precision-recall effects of conservative copying.
47	**Learning to Copy for Automatic Post-Editing** **File name:** *D19-1634.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Explicitly learns whether words should be copied during automatic post-editing of machine translation. This is a natural application because much of the original translation is already correct.
48	**Wiktionary Normalization of Translations and Morphological Information** **File name:** *2020.coling-main.413.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Shows copy attention improving sequence generation for morphological phenomena such as clipping, contraction and eye dialect. It broadens the copy-attention literature beyond standard text generation.
49	**Neural Multi-task Text Normalization and Sanitization with Pointer-Generator** **File name:** *2020.nli-1.5.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Uses pointer-generator behavior to copy OOV or unchanged text segments while jointly normalizing and sanitizing text. Relevant to copy-heavy transformation tasks.
50	**Pointer-Generator Networks for Low-Resource Machine Translation: Don't Copy That!** **File name:** *2024.insights-1.9.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	A modern critical reassessment of explicit pointer-generators for low-resource MT. Particularly valuable because it provides negative/limiting evidence in the era of subword tokenization and Transformers.
51	**Learn to Code-Switch: Data Augmentation using Copy Mechanism on Language Modeling** **File name:** *1810.10254.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Uses pointer networks to align and select words from parallel monolingual sentences to generate code-switched text. It demonstrates copy-based sequence construction for multilingual data augmentation.
6. Information Extraction, Dialogue and Semantic Parsing			
52	**Extracting Relational Facts by an End-to-End Neural Model with Copy Mechanism** **File name:** *P18-1047.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	A major early generative relation-extraction model (CopyRE). The decoder produces relation triples and copies entity mentions from the source sentence.
53	**CopyMTL: Copy Mechanism for Joint Extraction of Entities and Relations with Multi-Task Learning** **File name:** *6351.pdf*	OPEN RESOURCE	Extends CopyRE-style extraction with multi-task learning to better handle entity boundaries and multi-token entities. Important for generative joint entity-relation extraction.
54	**GenerativeRE: Incorporating a Novel Copy Mechanism and Pretrained Model for Joint Entity and Relation Extraction** **File name:** *2021.findings-emnlp.182.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Combines pretrained generation with a constrained copy mechanism for joint entity and relation extraction. It illustrates how copy constraints can reduce invalid structured outputs.
55	**A sequence-to-sequence approach for document-level relation extraction** **File name:** *2022.bionlp-1.2.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Treats document-level relation extraction as sequence generation while preserving source mentions through copying. Useful for longer-context structured extraction.
56	**Mem2Seq: Effectively Incorporating Knowledge Bases into End-to-End Task-Oriented Dialog Systems** **File name:** *P18-1136.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Combines multi-hop memory attention with a pointer network so task-oriented dialogue systems can copy entities and values from knowledge sources into responses.
57	**TRADE: Transferable Multi-Domain State Generator for Task-Oriented Dialogue Systems** **File name:** *P19-1078.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Uses a copy-augmented state generator to produce open-vocabulary slot values from dialogue context. Copying helps transfer across domains without a fixed ontology of slot values.
58	**GCDST: A Graph-based and Copy-augmented Multi-domain Dialogue State Tracking** **File name:** *2020.findings-emnlp.95.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Combines graph modeling with copy augmentation for multi-domain dialogue-state tracking, including reusing historical state information rather than regenerating every value.

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59	**Improving Limited Labeled Dialogue State Tracking with Self-Supervision** **File name:** *2020.findings-emnlp.400.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Analyzes copy-attention behavior in low-label dialogue-state tracking and shows how self-supervision changes the learned copy distribution. Useful for interpretability of copy attention.
60	**Learning to Retrieve Entity-Aware Knowledge and Generate Responses with Copy Mechanism for Task-Oriented Dialogue Systems** **File name:** *2012.11937.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Combines entity-aware knowledge retrieval with response generation and source/knowledge copying. Representative of knowledge-grounded dialogue where factual entities must be preserved.
61	**CopyT5: Copy Mechanism and Post-Trained T5 for Speech-Aware Dialogue State Tracking System** **File name:** *2023.dstc-1.11.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Adds an explicit copy mechanism to a post-trained T5 system for dialogue-state tracking from speech-related inputs. Shows copying retained as a useful bias on top of large pretrained seq2seq models.
62	**Semantic Parsing with Dual Learning** **File name:** *P19-1007.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Evaluates copy mechanisms inside a dual-learning semantic-parsing framework. Useful as evidence that the value of copying can vary substantially with dataset and target representation.
63	**A Copy Mechanism for Handling Knowledge Base Elements in SPARQL Query Generation** **File name:** *2022.findings-aacl.22.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Introduces a dynamic knowledge-base vocabulary and copying layer for SPARQL generation. It targets identifiers, resources, classes and properties that are difficult for a fixed vocabulary.
64	**PG-GSQL: Pointer-Generator Network with Guide Decoding for Cross-Domain Context-Dependent Text-to-SQL Generation** **File name:** *2020.coling-main.33.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Uses a pointer-generator to copy tokens from previous SQL while generating new SQL tokens under guided decoding. It is a clear structured-generation application of copy attention.
65	**Discourse Representation Structure Parsing with Recurrent Neural Networks and the Transformer Model** **File name:** *W19-1203.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Uses OpenNMT-style copy attention in neural semantic representation parsing. It is a useful example of copy attention in symbolic meaning-representation generation.
66	**Code Generation from Natural Language with Less Prior Knowledge and More Monolingual Data** **File name:** *2021.acl-short.98.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Uses a Transformer seq2seq model with copy attention for semantic parsing/code generation while deliberately minimizing task-specific architecture. Useful for comparing copying against heavier inductive biases.
7. Data-to-Text, Knowledge-to-Text, Code, Editing and Speech			
67	**End-to-End Content and Plan Selection for Data-to-Text Generation** **File name:** *1810.04700.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Particularly useful as a reference because it discusses and experiments with multiple copy-attention and coverage variants in data-to-text generation. It connects content planning with copy control.
68	**Point Precisely: Towards Ensuring the Precision of Data in Generated Texts Using Delayed Copy Mechanism** **File name:** *C18-1089.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Uses a two-stage strategy that first generates a template and then fills factual slots by copying from structured input. The delayed-copy design targets precise reproduction of entities and numbers.
69	**Describing a Knowledge Base** **File name:** *1809.01797.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Uses pointer/copy behavior in knowledge-base-to-text generation so factual values can be reproduced from structured records. Relevant to faithful data verbalization.
70	**Text Generation from Knowledge Graphs with Graph Transformers** **File name:** *N19-1238.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	A major graph-to-text Transformer reference with mechanisms for preserving input graph information in generated text. Useful context for copy-aware structured generation.
71	**Copy mechanism and tailored training for character-based data-to-text generation** **File name:** *1904.11838.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Introduces a character-level data-to-text model that alternates between generation and direct copying of input facts. It removes much of the need for delexicalization/relexicalization pipelines.
72	**A Transformer-based Approach for Source Code Summarization** **File name:** *2020.acl-main.449.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Adds a copy-attention layer to a Transformer so rare source-code identifiers such as variable and function names can be reproduced in natural-language summaries.
73	**C3PO: A Lightweight Copying Mechanism for Translating Pseudocode to Code** **File name:** *2022.aacl-srw.7.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Uses a lightweight generate/copy/combine mechanism for pseudocode-to-code translation. Relevant when exact symbols and identifiers must be preserved while code structure is generated.

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74	**Automatic Fact-guided Sentence Modification** **File name:** *1909.13838.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Uses a two-encoder seq2seq architecture with copy attention to update sentences according to new factual claims. It is a natural example of copy-aware text editing.
75	**CopyNE: Better Contextual ASR by Copying Named Entities** **File name:** *2024.acl-long.147.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Copies named entities as whole units from contextual dictionaries in ASR. A modern extension of copying from source tokens to copying structured entity spans from external context.
8. Transformer and LLM-era Copying			
76	**Revisiting the Architectures like Pointer Networks to Efficiently Improve the Next Word Distribution** **File name:** *2023.findings-acl.805.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Revisits pointer-style architectures for modern language modeling and next-word distributions. Useful for understanding whether contextual pointing still offers benefits alongside large neural vocabularies.
77	**LargePiG: Your Large Language Model is Secretly a Pointer Generator** **File name:** *2410.11366.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Proposes a training-free pointer-generator interpretation of LLM behavior, using internal attention as a pointer distribution and combining it with vocabulary generation. Motivated partly by grounded generation and hallucination reduction.
78	**Listening to the Wise Few: Select-and-Copy Attention Heads for Multiple-Choice QA** **File name:** *2410.02343.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Identifies attention heads in LLMs with select-and-copy behavior for multiple-choice reasoning. It shifts the question from adding an explicit copy module to detecting emergent copy-like circuitry.
79	**CopySpec: Accelerating LLMs with Speculative Copy-and-Paste** **File name:** *2025.emnlp-main.1337.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Applies copying to LLM inference efficiency: repeated spans in context are proposed as speculative continuations and verified by the model. It extends the copy idea from modeling to decoding acceleration.
9. Surveys, Toolkits and Reference Hubs			
80	**The OpenNMT Neural Machine Translation Toolkit: 2020 Edition** **File name:** *2020.amta-research.9.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Toolkit paper documenting practical support for copy-attention mechanisms among other seq2seq components. Useful as a software-oriented reference for implementing copy-capable models.
81	**OpenNMT Features - Copy Attention / Coverage Attention** **File name:** *WEB RESOURCE (no PDF filename)*	OPEN RESOURCE	Official framework documentation explicitly listing copy attention and coverage attention. Use this as an implementation reference rather than a research paper.
82	**A Survey of Generative Information Extraction** **File name:** *2025.coling-main.324.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Positions copy mechanisms and pointer networks within generative information extraction and constrained decoding. A good survey for discovering additional IE-specific copy papers.
83	**A Survey on Neural Question Generation** **File name:** *2402.18267.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Surveys neural question generation and traces attention, pointer and copy mechanisms across major QG architectures. Useful for locating additional application-specific references.
84	**A Comprehensive Survey of Abstractive Text Summarization Based on Deep Learning** **File name:** *PMC9359827.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Broad survey of abstractive summarization that discusses CopyNet, pointer-generator networks and related mechanisms. Helpful for placing copy attention in the historical summarization landscape.
85	**Pre-trained Language Models for Text Generation: A Survey** **File name:** *2201.05273.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Broad text-generation survey that treats attention and copying as important neural generation techniques and provides context for the transition to pretrained language models.
86	**Paraphrase Generation: A Survey of the State of the Art** **File name:** *2021.emnlp-main.414.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Survey of paraphrase generation that includes copy-based approaches among neural methods. Useful for finding copying applied to controlled rewriting and paraphrase generation.
87	**Keyphrase Extraction and Generation - NLP Progress** **File name:** *WEB RESOURCE (no PDF filename)*	OPEN RESOURCE	Reference hub tracking keyphrase-generation datasets, methods and results. Useful for following the CopyRNN lineage and discovering later keyphrase-generation work.
10. Gap-Search Additions - Missing from the Prior Index / Uploaded Collection			
88	**Efficient Summarization with Read-Again and Copy Mechanism** **File name:** *1611.03382.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Early copy-aware summarization model. It adds a read-again encoder and a simple copy mechanism designed to work with a small decoder vocabulary while handling OOV source words.

#	TITLE / FILE NAME	DOWNLOAD LINK	ANNOTATION / WHY IT MATTERS
89	**Language as a Latent Variable: Discrete Generative Models for Sentence Compression** **File name:** *D16-1031.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Introduces the Forced-Attention Sentence Compression formulation referenced by later pointer-generator work. It combines latent compression with pointer-style selection and is an important parallel branch to CopyNet.
90	**A Copy-Augmented Sequence-to-Sequence Architecture Gives Good Performance on Task-Oriented Dialogue** **File name:** *E17-2075.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	One of the earliest direct applications of copy-augmented seq2seq to task-oriented dialogue. Selective attention and copying let the decoder reproduce relevant entities from dialogue history without an explicit symbolic belief state.
91	**Generating Natural Answers by Incorporating Copying and Retrieving Mechanisms in Sequence-to-Sequence Learning** **File name:** *P17-1019.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	COREQA jointly generates ordinary vocabulary tokens, copies semantic units from the question, and retrieves answer units from a knowledge base. It broadens copy attention from one source sequence to mixed source-plus-KB generation.
92	**DeepCopy: Grounded Response Generation with Hierarchical Pointer Networks** **File name:** *W19-5917.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Extends pointer-generator dialogue generation with hierarchical attention/copying over both conversational context and external unstructured knowledge. Important for grounded response generation.
93	**A Pointer Network Architecture for Context-Dependent Semantic Parsing** **File name:** *U19-1013.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Uses a pointer/copy mechanism to fill logical-form arguments directly from the utterance while modeling conversational context. A useful bridge from copy attention to structured semantic parsing.
94	**Core Semantic First: A Top-down Approach for AMR Parsing** **File name:** *D19-1393.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	AMR concept prediction combines vocabulary generation with copying input tokens or mapping them to aligned concepts. It shows copy mechanisms handling sparse structured-output vocabularies rather than ordinary text generation.
95	**Controlling the Amount of Verbatim Copying in Abstractive Summarization** **File name:** *1911.10390.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Directly studies controllable copying: the summarizer can produce hypotheses ranging from highly extractive to highly generative by controlling source-copy behavior during training and decoding.
96	**Concept Extraction Using Pointer-Generator Networks** **File name:** *2008.11295.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Applies a pointer-generator with distant supervision to open-domain concept extraction, emphasizing OOV concepts and demonstrating that copy/generate decoding can function as an extraction model.
97	**Dr. Summarize: Global Summarization of Medical Dialogue by Exploiting Local Structures** **File name:** *2020.findings-emnlp.335.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	A medical-dialogue pointer-generator variant that modulates generation/copy behavior and explicitly models negation. It is a strong domain-specific example where what is copied matters for factual safety.
98	**OCR Post Correction for Endangered Language Texts** **File name:** *2020.emnlp-main.478.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Uses copy-augmented seq2seq for low-resource OCR post-correction, where much of the output should stay identical to the noisy input. Demonstrates copying outside conventional text generation and improves error rates in data-scarce languages.
99	**Logic2Text: High-Fidelity Natural Language Generation from Logical Forms** **File name:** *2020.findings-emnlp.190.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Includes Transformer+copy and pointer-generator baselines for generating text from logical forms/tables. The copy switch is especially useful for factual entities and numbers, making this relevant to faithful structured-data generation.
100	**A Topic Guided Pointer-Generator Model for Generating Natural Language Code Summaries** **File name:** *2107.01642.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Combines broader code-context topics with pointer-generator decoding so identifiers and code terms can be copied while natural-language summary words are generated. Useful for copy mechanisms in code-to-text NLP.
101	**A Template-guided Hybrid Pointer Network for Knowledge-based Task-oriented Dialogue Systems** **File name:** *2021.dialdoc-1.3.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Uses retrieved guidance responses and a gated memory pointer network for task-oriented dialogue. It extends copy-based dialogue generation with template/retrieval guidance for more informative and stable responses.
102	**Position Offset Label Prediction for Grammatical Error Correction** **File name:** *2022.coling-1.480.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Proposes P-copy, a copy mechanism guided by predicted token position-offset labels. It explicitly incorporates insertion, substitution, deletion, and reordering signals into copy decisions for multilingual GEC.

#	TITLE / FILE NAME	DOWNLOAD LINK	ANNOTATION / WHY IT MATTERS
103	**Multilingual Generative Language Models for Zero-Shot Cross-Lingual Event Argument Extraction** **File name:** *2022.acl-long.317.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	X-GEAR adds a copy distribution derived from cross-attention to multilingual generative models so event arguments can be copied into language-agnostic templates. The paper includes ablations showing when explicit copying helps mT5 versus mBART.
104	**Investigating Math Word Problems using Pretrained Multilingual Language Models** **File name:** *2022.mathnlp-1.2.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Builds multilingual math-word-problem solvers as seq2seq models with copying. It is relevant because numerical constants and problem-specific symbols are natural candidates for exact source copying.
105	**A Simple Recipe for Lexically Constrained Text Generation** **File name:** *2024.inlg-main.1.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	A modern constrained-generation reference that revisits the role of copying after subword tokenization and uses copy/template ideas for enforcing lexical constraints. Useful for understanding why copy mechanisms remain relevant beyond OOV handling.
106	**SARCAT: Generative Span-Act Guided Response Generation Using Copy-Enhanced Target Augmentation** **File name:** *2024.findings-emnlp.867.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Adds a copy mechanism to target-side augmentation and predicts grounding spans/dialogue acts before response generation. A recent example of copy-aware document-grounded dialogue with pretrained T5.
107	**BLooP: Zero-Shot Abstractive Summarization using Large Language Models with Bigram Lookahead Promotion** **File name:** *2603.11415.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	A 2026 training-free LLM-era copy mechanism. Instead of learning a pointer distribution, BLooP biases next-token probabilities toward bigrams found in the source document to improve faithfulness and reduce hallucination without fine-tuning.
11. Further Additions - Copy Control and Mechanistic LLM Copying			
108	**Dynamic Multi-Level Multi-Task Learning for Sentence Simplification** **File name:** *C18-1039.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Adds a pointer-copy mechanism to sentence simplification and combines it with multi-level multi-task learning for related semantic objectives. It is a useful missing application of classical copy attention in controlled rewriting.
109	**Strategies for Structuring Story Generation** **File name:** *P19-1254.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Uses pointer/copy behavior to improve entity consistency in story generation, allowing previously introduced entities and related representations to be reused instead of repeatedly regenerated.
110	**Document-level Entity-based Extraction as Template Generation** **File name:** *2021.emnlp-main.426.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	TEMPGEN frames document-level entity extraction as template generation and introduces TopK Copy, using cross-attention to guide copying from the source. Important for copy-aware generative information extraction.
111	**Controllable Text Simplification with Explicit Paraphrasing** **File name:** *2021.naacl-main.277.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Studies controllable simplification with explicit paraphrasing and incorporates copy-related information into the representation. It is useful for understanding copy control in editing rather than pure generation.
112	**Evidence-based Factual Error Correction** **File name:** *2021.acl-long.256.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Relevant to copy-aware editing and factual correction: the task often requires retaining most source material while selectively replacing unsupported spans using evidence. Useful for comparing explicit copy/edit biases with pretrained seq2seq models.
113	**AMPERE: AMR-Aware Prefix for Generation-Based Event Argument Extraction Model** **File name:** *2023.acl-long.615.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Combines AMR-aware prefix information with an adjusted copy mechanism for generation-based event argument extraction. It shows how copying can be guided by structured semantic information in a Transformer-era model.
114	**Language Models “Grok” to Copy** **File name:** *2409.09281.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	A modern mechanistic study of how Transformer language models acquire contextual copying during training. It connects emergent copying behavior to induction-style attention circuits and is a key bridge from explicit copy modules to internal LLM copying.
115	**CODEPROMPTZIP: Code-specific Prompt Compression for Retrieval-Augmented Generation in Coding Tasks with LMs** **File name:** *2502.14925.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Applies copy-aware compression to retrieved code context for RAG-based coding tasks. It is useful for seeing copying used as a preservation mechanism inside modern prompt-compression pipelines.
116	**CoCoLex: Confidence-guided Copy-based Decoding for Grounded Legal Text Generation** **File name:** *2508.05534.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	A modern LLM decoding reference that interpolates ordinary vocabulary generation with a context-copy distribution under confidence control. Conceptually close to a pointer-generator adapted to grounded LLM generation.
117	**Dialogue-RAG: Enhancing Retrieval for LLMs via Node-Linking Utterance Rewriting** **File name:** *2025.acl-long.1191.pdf*	DOWNLOAD PDF	Uses pointer-style mechanisms in dialogue rewriting for retrieval-augmented generation, controlling which information is copied from conversational context versus the current utterance. Useful for modern multi-source copy routing.

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118	**ICICLE: Expanding Retrieval with In-Context Documents** **File name:** *2605.26902.pdf*	**DOWNLOAD PDF**	A recent generative-retrieval reference using an explicit copy-routing behavior for in-context document identifiers. It generalizes generate-versus-copy decisions from source tokens to retrieval targets and in-context resources.
119	**In-context Learning and Induction Heads** **File name:** *2209.11895.pdf*	**DOWNLOAD PDF**	Foundational mechanistic-interpretability work on induction heads. The attention circuit retrieves a previous token pattern and copies the token that followed it, providing an important internal-attention analogue of classical pointer/copy mechanisms.
120	**The Dual-Route Model of Induction** **File name:** *2504.03022.pdf*	**DOWNLOAD PDF**	Studies multiple routes by which language models perform induction and lexical copying, including behavior that can operate over multi-token concepts. Useful for understanding how token-level and concept-level copying emerge inside LLMs.
121	**Unveiling Induction Heads: Provable Training Dynamics and Feature Learning in Transformers** **File name:** *2409.10559.pdf*	**DOWNLOAD PDF**	Provides theoretical analysis of how induction-head behavior is learned in Transformers. It is valuable for a copy-attention study because it formalizes the emergence of attention circuits that retrieve and reproduce contextual patterns.

Search vocabulary for continued discovery

"copy attention" • "copy mechanism" • "copying mechanism" • "pointer generator" • "pointer-generator" • "pointer softmax" • "pointer-softmax" • CopyNet • CopyRNN • "copy-augmented" • "copy decoder" • "copy distribution" • "copy gate" • "span copying" • "phrase-level copying" • "source copying" • "generate or copy" • "pointer network" NLP • "select-and-copy attention"

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